

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, some sun early, clouds late, afternoon storms, high 89. **Tonight**, thunderstorms, rather cloudy, low 62. **Tomorrow**, cooler, some sun, high 79. Weather map is on Page 20.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



PETE KIEHART FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

No Longer Trump-Branded
Workers removed the president's name from the Kennedy Center on Saturday morning in compliance with a court order. Page 21.

Ukraine War Has Outlasted 1st World War

By CONSTANT MÉHEUT

The war in Ukraine has often been compared to World War I for its brutal infantry assaults and heavy casualties. Yet the idea that it could, by any measure, surpass a conflict so long and bloody that French soldiers hoped it would be “the last of the last” once seemed unthinkable.

That is just what happened on Thursday. The war in Ukraine — which reached 1,569 days, or more than four years and three months — has now outlasted World War I.

When President Vladimir V. Putin of Russia sent his troops into Ukraine in February 2022, he believed the government would fall within days. After Ukraine pushed the Russians back and the conflict settled into a war of attrition, even many of those fighting could not imagine it would last this long.

“I thought maybe two or three years, and then politicians will find some kind of consensus,” said a Ukrainian soldier who, for security reasons, gave only his call sign, France, a nod to his time in the French Foreign Legion.

But the war has raged on, and, with peace talks stalled, it shows no sign of ending soon. Polls suggest that about half of Ukrainians believe it will not end before next year, which would push it closer to another threshold: the duration of World War II, which lasted six years. And there are many Ukrainians who would argue that the current war really began in 2014 when Russian troops seized Crimea.

Historians caution that drawing parallels with the two world wars has limits. The global scale of those conflicts, involving many theaters and armies, makes comparisons about casualties and firepower difficult. Ukraine did not exist as a country during World War I.

Still, the war in Ukraine, like World War I, is likely to rank among the most consequential conflicts in modern European history, said Yaroslav Hrytsak, a Ukrainian historian. Both wars transformed Europe's geopolitics by reshaping military alliances

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The Existential Dread of a Deepfake Expert

By ELI SASLOW

BERKELEY, Calif. — The emails began to arrive on a Sunday morning, as the worst ones often did. Hany Farid opened the first message at his home in the hills above Berkeley and found a link to a viral video purporting to show a U.S.-made missile hitting an elementary school in Iran, where more than 150 people had been killed, most of them children. “Is this an internet hoax or an international war crime?” one note read. “We’re trying to verify what’s real.”

Farid grabbed a pencil and a notepad, leaned into his computer and watched. He saw blue sky, telephone wires and a few palm

Ever More Refined A.I. Works Bedevil Even the Sharpest Eyes

trees swaying in the wind. And then a missile streaked across the screen, clear and unmistakable even at 500 miles per hour. It looked like a scene from a video game. In the last few days, Farid had reviewed dozens of convincing A.I.-generated videos of fake bombings, fake plane crashes, fake fires and fake executions. His instinct was to be skeptical. He was nearly certain the video was another fake.

He chewed on his pencil and watched it again, slowing down the video, breaking it apart frame by frame. The camera shook in a way that seemed plausible for an amateur filming with a cellphone. The shadows were geometrically accurate. He watched the missile strike a building and noticed a short delay before he heard an explosion and high-pitched screams, which seemed consistent with the speed of sound. Maybe the video was real. It had already been viewed at least 1.1 million times on social media. With each passing second, it was becoming reality, whether it was real or not.

“Anyone can create a video of anything or anybody, doing or

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THE METROPOLITAN MUSEUM OF ART



THE MUSEUM OF MODERN ART/LICENSED BY SCALA, VIA ART RESOURCE, NY



MUSEO NACIONAL DEL PRADO

Getting an Eyeful, and Staying With It

The 10-Minute Challenge, a popular series from The Upshot, asks readers online to look at a work of art for that long, and we’re passing that challenge on to you. We’ve selected six artworks from the series, each its own, sometimes enormous, single page. Pull them out; tape them up on your wall. Set a timer, or don’t. Put down your phone, shut out the world and really *look*. A special section.

World Cup Peels Argentines Away From Phones and Has Them Stuck on Stickers

By EMMA BUBOLA and LUCÍA CHOLAKIAN HERRERA

BUENOS AIRES — The children swiped fast across the colorful images. Their thumbs flicked from one square to the next, their eyes tracking the images, seemingly hypnotized, pausing only to show one another what had become their class's viral sensation.

Held tightly in their hands weren't smartphones, iPads or video game controllers, but motionless, low-tech stacks of paper stickers.

In the weeks leading up to the World Cup, Argentines were hunting to fill sticker albums with the faces of every player on every team competing in the tournament.

Driven in part by a contagious

hype, the need to soothe World Cup anxiety in a soccer-obsessed nation and the persistence of an intergenerational tradition, Argentina has been swept by a collecting fever that seems immune to the digital revolution that has obliterated so many other analog pastimes.

For several weeks, Argentine children have left their smartphones untouched for long

stretches as they have gathered to swap stickers in schoolyards, parks, supermarkets, shopping malls and below the same ombú trees where their parents and grandparents once met long ago to trade postal stamps and coins.

“This is like a social network,” Dana Blecker, a mother of two, said as she stood on a recent Saturday among a large crowd of elementary schoolchildren trading

stickers at a Buenos Aires park. “But an alive social network.”

Barely managing to clench the tall stacks of stickers in their small hands, the children moved from one huddle to another, asking for specific players (“Do you have Julián Álvarez?” a top Argentine player) or nations (“Any from Scotland or Saudi Arabia?”).

Many held handwritten paper

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INTERNATIONAL 14-14	OBITUARIES 29-31	ARTS & LEISURE	SUNDAY BUSINESS	SUNDAY OPINION
A Swiss Population Cap? One of the world's richest countries is voting Sunday on a measure — sold in warm tones — that would curb migration and perhaps the economy. PAGE 4	A Pun-Filled Film Critic Gene Shalit delivered his wacky commentary on movies and other arts for more than 40 years on the “Today” show on NBC. He was 100. PAGE 30	Centennial of a Visionary The choreographer Martha Graham took a barefoot leap for modern dance 100 years ago. Her influence continues to reverberate. PAGE 6	They Tried to Catch a Predator What happened when livestreaming vigilantes, part of a venture that traffics in public humiliation as entertainment, ambushed an innocent man? PAGE 6	Jody Rosen PAGE 6



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